PITCH SCRIPT v2 · 2:50 TARGET · 3:10 HARD CAP

# FLOODS ARE PREDICTABLE. RESPONSE SHOULDN'T BE THE PART THAT ISN'T.

One story, told live through both views. The demo is the pitch; everything before it earns the right to show it, and everything after it makes it stick.

| Cold open | Problem | The loop | Live demo | Close | Buffer |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0:00–0:15 | 0:15–0:40 | 0:40–0:55 | 0:55–2:30 | 2:30–2:50 | 2:50–3:10 |

### How to read this

**Gold bold** = say close to verbatim. Plain text = talking points in your own words. *[Gray brackets]* = what to do on screen. [Highlighted] = fill in with your real numbers before you pitch. If you can't back a highlighted claim, cut the line rather than guess.

## 00 · COLD OPEN

0:00–0:15

VISUAL
HAMZAH

*[Full-screen photo of a flooded New Brunswick road during Ida. Say nothing for three full seconds.]*

HOOK
HAMZAH

**"September 2021. Hurricane Ida. This is [Route 18 / road in photo], about a mile from this room."**
**"When a flood hits campus, the first thing that breaks down isn't the roads. It's information."**

## 01 · THE PROBLEM

0:15–0:40

GAP
HAMZAH

Students don't know which paths are underwater. Responders don't know where to go first.
**"And in a flood, minutes decide whether someone gets stranded or gets home."**

WHO
HAMZAH

It hits hardest for people who can't just glance at a map and go: students with disabilities, anyone without a car, anyone who needs more than "avoid Route 18."

WHY NOW
HAMZAH

**"Alerts tell you there's a flood. Maps don't know which paths are underwater. Nothing connects the students who see it to the people who can respond."**

## 02 · THE LOOP

**0:40–0:55**

| | |
|---|---|
| THESIS<br>HAMZAH | **“So we built one loop: predict, detect, report, respond.”** |
| MAP IT<br>HAMZAH | **Predict**: a model on live Raritan gauge and elevation data. **Detect**: our own water-level sensor plus cameras. **Report**: students, one photo. **Respond**: coordinators dispatch and reroute. Two sides: **RU Ready** for students, **Flood Command** for coordinators. |
| HANDOFF<br>HAMZAH | **“Let us show you, using one student’s afternoon.”** |

## 03 · LIVE DEMO: ONE STORY

**0:55–2:30**

Every beat moves the same story forward. If a feature doesn’t serve the story, it doesn’t get screen time; save it for Q&A.

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 · LIVE<br>HAMZAH<br>0:55–1:05 | *[Flood Command on screen. Point at the river panel.]* **“This is Flood Command. That’s the actual Raritan level, right now.”** *Only say “right now” if the feed is genuinely live.* |
| 2 · PROOF<br>HAMZAH<br>1:05–1:20 | **“First question you should ask: does the model work? We ran it on Ida’s river data. It flagged [road] [X hours] before it flooded.”** *[Show the backtest stat or chart for two seconds.]* |
| 3 · WOW<br>HAMZAH<br>1:20–1:45 | **“Now: what if the river rises another [3 feet]?”** *[Drag the what-if slider slowly. Let roads turn red. Stop talking for two seconds.]* Every red road is one the model expects underwater; the risk ranking on the right re-sorts live. |
| 4 · REPORT<br>HASSAN<br>1:45–2:00 | *[Switch to RU Ready.]* **“Meet Maya, on College Ave. She sees water on her path.”** *[Tap report, snap photo, submit.]* **“Five seconds.”** |
| 5 · RESPOND<br>HAMZAH + [SENSOR LEAD]<br>2:00–2:15 | *[Switch to Flood Command.]* Her report lands instantly. *[Sensor lead points at the hardware reading.]* Our sensor confirms it. [N] people in this zone right now. One tap signals the nearest unit. *If dispatch is simulated, say “signals” and own it in Q&A.* |
| 6 · GUIDE<br>HASSAN<br>2:15–2:30 | *[Switch to RU Ready.]* **“Maya’s route updates. And if she can’t read a map —”** *[Play voice guidance OUT LOUD. Let 3–4 seconds run.]* **“— it walks her to the nearest shelter.”** |

## 04 · CLOSE

2:30–2:50

| | |
|---|---|
| LOOP<br>HAMZAH | **“Predict. Detect. Report. Respond. One system, built for the people at risk and the people trying to help them.”** |
| NEXT<br>HAMZAH | Next step: a pilot with [Rutgers Office of Emergency Management], more gauges, then any campus or town that sits on a gauged river. |
| CALLBACK<br>HAMZAH | **“When the next flood hits, information shouldn’t be the first thing to break. Thank you.”**<br>*[Stop. Don’t trail off. Smile, wait for questions.]* |

## 05 · PRE-FLIGHT

before you go up

| | |
|---|---|
| FILL EVERY HIGHLIGHT | Backtest number, Ida photo location, people count, sensor lead’s name. No number you can’t defend. |
| BACKUP RECORDING | Screen-record the full demo story. If Wi-Fi or the app fails, switch to it without apologizing. |
| AUDIO CHECK | Confirm laptop volume and venue speakers so the voice guidance is audible from the back row. |
| PRE-STAGE TABS | Flood Command and RU Ready open side by side, logged in, slider reset, Maya’s report ready to submit. |
| RUN IT 3× LIVE | Full run-throughs with the real demo, timed. Target 2:50. Practice the switches, not just the words. |
| MEMORIZE THE EDGES | First 15 and last 15 seconds cold. Eyes on judges, not the screen. |
| CHECK THE RUBRIC | Read HackRU judging criteria and your prize tracks; make sure each one gets an explicit moment. |

# Q&A · PREP SHEET

**15 sec per answer**

Answer in one sentence, add one supporting detail, stop. Skip “great question.” If you don’t know, say what you’d do to find out. The answer frames below are starting points; replace the highlights with what’s actually true of your build.

**Q1** HAMZAH

**How accurate is the model? What trained it?**

Trained on [USGS gauge IDs] and [elevation source]. On the Ida backtest it [result]. It’s a hackathon model; the next step is validating on more historical events.

**Q2** HAMZAH

**What’s real and what’s mocked?**

Say it first and confidently: real is [live gauge, sensor, reporting, routing]; simulated is [agency dispatch, population data]. Judges reward honesty and punish getting caught.

**Q3** HAMZAH

**Where does population density come from?**

Today: [source or simulation]. In production: aggregated campus Wi-Fi connection counts per zone, with no individual tracking.

**Q4** HASSAN

**What about privacy?**

Density is aggregated by zone. Reports carry a photo and a location only when the student submits one. [Confirm what you actually store.]

**Q5** HASSAN

**Why would students download another app?**

[Your real answer, e.g. a link pushed through existing Rutgers alerts, report without signup.]

**Q6** HAMZAH

**Who adopts this, and who pays?**

University emergency management first, then municipalities. One flood day of closures and rescues costs far more than the software.

**Q7** [SENSOR LEAD]

**What if the network or sensor goes down?**

Multiple independent inputs (model, sensor, cameras, reports) cross-check each other, so one failing doesn’t blind the system. [Mention any offline or cached-route behavior.]

**Q8** [SENSOR LEAD]

**What does the sensor measure? What does it cost?**

ESP32 with [sensor type], about [$ cost] per unit, reporting over [Wi-Fi / LoRa].

**Q9** HAMZAH

**Does it scale beyond Rutgers?**

Anywhere with a gauged river. The model retrains per location, and the map, shelters and zones are config.

**Q10** ANY

**What would you build next with more time?**

Validate the model on more events, wire real dispatch through an agency partner, and add SMS for students without data.